

e-Granthalaya

E-Granthalaya: A Digital Library Management System

Introduction

E-Granthalaya is a **Library Management Software (LMS)** developed by the **National Informatics Centre (NIC), Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY), Government of India**. It is designed to automate library operations, manage digital resources, and provide seamless access to library materials through a cloud-based platform.

The software helps **government, academic, research, and public libraries** maintain their collections efficiently, offering features like **cataloging, circulation management, digital repository creation, and online public access catalog (OPAC)**. With its latest version, **E-Granthalaya 4.0**, hosted on the **NIC Cloud**, it provides a **secure, cost-effective, and user-friendly** solution for modern libraries.

E-Granthalaya supports **multi-library networks**, allowing institutions to share resources and collaborate effectively. It plays a crucial role in **digitalizing libraries in India**, ensuring wider access to knowledge while reducing the dependency on manual record-keeping.

Features of E-Granthalaya

E-Granthalaya is designed to meet the evolving needs of modern libraries by incorporating various **automation and digitalization features**:

1. Cloud-Based Library Automation

The latest version, **E-Granthalaya 4.0**, operates on the **Cloud** and is hosted by NIC. This cloud-based model eliminates the need for individual libraries to maintain separate IT infrastructure, reducing maintenance costs and ensuring data security.

2. Online Public Access Catalog (OPAC)

The OPAC feature allows users to search and browse the library catalog online. It supports **multi-library integration**, enabling access to a **centralized library database** across institutions.

3. Cataloging and Classification

E-Granthalaya supports **MARC21, AACR2, and other cataloging standards**, making it compatible with international library norms. It provides tools for **metadata management** and **barcode-based book identification**, streamlining the classification process.

4. Membership and Circulation Management

Libraries can **manage memberships, issue books, track returns, and generate overdue alerts** through an automated system. The software supports **RFID-based book issuance**, making borrowing and returning books more efficient.

5. Digital Library & E-Resources Management

E-Granthalaya allows libraries to create a **digital repository** of books, research papers, articles, and other documents. It can also integrate with **open-access resources and e-journals**, expanding the availability of knowledge.

6. Multi-Library Network

Institutions can use E-Granthalaya to create a **network of libraries**, enabling resource sharing among different branches. This feature is especially beneficial for universities, research organizations, and government departments.

7. Mobile & Remote Access

With its web-based interface, E-Granthalaya allows **library members to access resources remotely**, making it easier to borrow e-books, check availability, and renew books online.

8. Reporting and Analytics

The system provides detailed **reports and analytics** on book circulation, member activity, and resource utilization, helping libraries make data-driven decisions.

Advantages of E-Granthalaya

1. Being a **government - supported initiative**, it provides an **affordable solution** for public and institutional libraries.
2. **Cloud Security** – Since it is hosted by **NIC Cloud**, the data is **secure and regularly backed up**.
3. **User-Friendly Interface** – The software is **easy to use**, making it accessible for both **librarians and users**.
4. **Integration with National Digital Library (NDL)** – It allows integration with **NDL and other online repositories**, expanding research opportunities.
5. **Supports Government and Academic Libraries** – It is widely used by **schools, colleges, universities, and government departments** across India.

Implementation and Usage of E-Granthalaya

E-Granthalaya is implemented in **various government, academic, research, and public libraries** across India. The **National Informatics Centre (NIC)** provides support for its installation, training, and maintenance. The implementation process involves the following steps:

1. **Library Registration** – Libraries interested in using E-Granthalaya must register through the official **NIC E-Granthalaya portal**.
2. **Cloud Hosting Setup** – The latest version, **E-Granthalaya 4.0**, is hosted on the **NIC Cloud**, eliminating the need for separate IT infrastructure.
3. **Data Migration and Cataloging** – Existing physical and digital resources are cataloged and entered into the system using **international standards like MARC21 and AACR2**.
4. **Training and User Support** – NIC provides **training sessions for librarians** to familiarize them with the software and its functionalities.

Conclusion

E-Granthalaya is a revolutionary step towards **digitalizing libraries in India**. It enhances the efficiency of library management, promotes **resource sharing**, and ensures easy access to knowledge through a **centralized digital library system**. By supporting **automation, cloud integration, and digital content management**, it is helping transform traditional libraries into modern, technology-driven knowledge hubs.